3 November 2008, updated 27 January 09

To: NZRA Management Committee
From: Grant Hunter, Secretary

Introducing a review of the management structure and regional representation of the New Zealand Rogaining Association

1. Background: Organisational structure issues for NZRA

The AGM of NZRA in February 2008 agreed it is timely to review the roles and structure of the Management Committee and regional representation of the New Zealand Rogaining Association, based on the original formation in 2002 and subsequent experience. It was resolved to put any proposals for changes to the AGM in 2009.

Things to consider

- Any changes needed to better deliver a national presence through the Management Committee, e.g., should the committee have a national spread?
- What is the status of the regional reps? Should regional reps. have Management Committee member status, or is their role a different one?
- Can the management committee and regional representation be better integrated?
- A sustainable organisation: What do we need to do, if anything, to ensure the association will be robust in say 5 years when some of the core initiators have a much reduced role?

2. The New Zealand Rogaining Association

The New Zealand Rogaining Association (NZRA) was established in 2002 to encourage, support and develop the sport of rogaining in New Zealand. At that time, as is still the case, rogaines and rogaine-like events are organised in many regions by a range of different groups (e.g., clubs, individuals and event businesses).

Rogaining was derived from the 24 hr walks run by Melbourne University and others. See http://www.rogaining.com/articles/factsheet.html. It has affinity to the more widely-known sport of orienteering, and many orienteering clubs organise rogaines as a part of their mapsport calendar. The foundation members of the NZRA believed that rogaining would grow more strongly by having a national body separate from orienteering, as there are very significant differences between the two sports in their purest sense. Two-thirds of the competitors in most rogaines had come from outside of orienteering circles, many being trampers or multisport and adventure-sport enthusiasts, and it is these people in particular that the foundation members felt would benefit most from this new Association. NZRA has no intent to act as 'the' association for all rogaining in New Zealand.

The NZRA is a non-profit, independent association which is registered as an Incorporated Society. It is intended to function as a low-overhead, low-cost organisation based on email

and website communications. Its full set of NZRA Rules is available at http://www.rogaine.org.nz/main/NZRArules14Nov02.htm .

2.1 Aims and achievements of NZRA

The following table lists the aims which NZRA was established to achieve. These are taken from the Association Rules, a full set of which can be found at www.rogaine.org.nz**.** Comment is made on achievements of NZRA for each aim.

Aim	Achievements summary
2.1 To facilitate and encourage the development of the sport of rogaining, or similar human-powered navigation and endurance events, anywhere in New Zealand.	Current membership of association is 1252, defined by an electronic mailing list compiled from accumulated event entries (742) plus individual sign-ups (510). NZRA has directly organised 17 events since formation, and organised and/or supported a total of some 45 events.
2.2 To establish event guidelines and give advice for events to the event organizers, regardless of any affiliation they may have with other organizations.	A range of resources are available on the Association website and verbal and practical advice is offered by members to both NZRA and non-NZRA individuals and groups. NZRA is noted for its open policy of supporting a wide range of event organisers. On the 'to do list' is to prepare an audited generic safety plan and template for rogaining in New Zealand.
2.3 To encourage participants in the sport to contribute towards the organization and running of events.	NZRA supports a range of individuals, groups and small businesses in event organisation. We note, as do many sports, an aging population of active rogaine organisers and the lack of younger people moving into event participation and organisation. We continue to seek resolution, with limited success.
2.4 To offer a Public Liability Insurance cover to any event which wishes to be affiliated to and has the approval of the NZRA.	Has provided public liability cover to 45-events since 2002, typically about 5/yr. Forest owners are particularly vigilant that we hold adequate insurance cover. Non-NZRA events using this umbrella cover pay to NZRA a small per person levy as a contribution to insurance premiums. Without such an umbrella insurance facility, at least some of these independent events would not have taken place.
2.5 To assist in the development of a suitable set of rules to apply to events which wish to be recognized as "championship" events.	NZRA has given NZ leadership by reviewing the rules of the ARA and adopting these for its own events, with several changes to reflect NZ competition. This approach has offered close alignment with international competition, while accommodating particular needs for NZ. Currently finalising negotiations with NZOF on jointly adopting these as an agreed set of rules for championship events in NZ.
2.6 To maintain a pool of rogaining equipment available for use to organizers of approved events.	Holdings of check point flags, signs, Start/Finish banner, bulk water containers, time clocks, GPS and mapping software etc. are available to NZRA and other events. A particular feature is the internationally unique system of electronic check point recorders (Navlight), developed by the NZRA President, available for use on a hire basis to association and non-association events (also used in Australia). Navlight is now owned and operated by the NZRA.
2.7 To maintain a website for the dissemination of information on events and results.	Comprehensive website at www.rogaine.org.nz. e.g., rules, code of conduct, guidance notes and instructions, rogaining stories, event calendar, event results and features. Updated regularly, plus 'seasonal' and email newsletters.

2.8 To work with the International Rogaining Federation to advance the sport of rogaining, both within New Zealand and internationally.	NZRA has the sole NZ delegate to the IRF. Input to structural revue of IRF. Input to forum on World Championship events. At the world championship in Eastern Europe in 2008, NZRA President Pete Squires was awarded the Geoduck award from IRF for services rendered to rogaining.
2.9 To organize rogaines directly.	NZRA directly organises 2 or 3 events each year, including (1) National Championship events and (2) the 'definitive' annual 12 hour rogaine, Heights of Winter in Canterbury, each organised in alternate years with NZOF There have been 17 events organised directly by NZRA since inception. Largest event had 333 participants.
2.10 To do anything else that would further any of these aims.	e.g., articles in magazines; Developed positive relationships with the agricultural and forestry sector in many regions of New Zealand to enable recreational access to land. (Much of this land is not routinely available for public use.)

2.2 Membership, financials and funding

- All participants entering an NZRA event must become a member of the Association. (this is to meet insurance requirements, participant buy-in to the NZRA code of conduct etc.).
- Other individuals interested in rogaining and willing to accept conditions of membership, such as adherence to the Code of Conduct are welcome to join NZRA.
- Membership is free from any subscription or other direct cost*. A downside of free membership is that there is no obvious mechanism to remove inactive people from the membership list, and also checking to avoid double entries to membership as each new event brings in a fresh tranche of new (and old) names.
- The core source of revenue for operating NZRA is the operating profit arising from the NZRA-organised events. A per-participant levy is payable by non-NZRA events operating under the NZRA umbrella public liability insurance cover. Currently set at $2 pp, this levy is intended to cover insurance and related costs, not as a source of general revenue for the Association.
- NZRA currently has banked funds to the value of ca. $27,000. It is in a financially viable situation.
- NZRA also has some value (several thousand dollars) tied up in assets such as check point markers, signs, GPS and mapping systems. There is also a very substantial capital asset in Navlight, in partnership with its developer.

*Note: NSW Rogaining Association now also offers free membership, with funding built into entry fees as for NZRA.

2.3 Organisational structure

The rules of NZRA (see http://www.rogaine.org.nz/main/NZRArules14Nov02.htm) make provision for:

- a Management Committee comprising President, Treasurer, Secretary, and three other members;
- formation, by the Management Committee, of subcommittees which will have the same powers as the Management Committee

- the Management Committee to co-opt up to three additional people, on an annual term basis.

2.4 Current committee structure

At the outset, formation of NZRA was largely a Christchurch based initiative. It is thus not surprising, despite the intent to operate as a national association, the first Management Committee was solely Christchurch based. It is more significant that in 2008 the Management Committee continues to be almost entirely based in Christchurch.

Since 2002, the need for a regional (i.e., national) presence and activity has been met by establishing regional representatives. Regional representatives have been recommended and appointed by the Management Committee on a pragmatic basis, striving to deliver a presence in rogaining hot spots and growth areas in New Zealand, as well as ensuring regional coverage across all of New Zealand.

Roles and responsibilities of regional representatives have not been formally addressed in terms of the rules of the Association. In 2008 the Secretary informally defined the role of regional representatives as: "The function of regional representatives is to be eyes and ears for the NZRA, and to be advocates for rogaining (including event organisation), consistent with the aims of NZRA".

The Management Committee has also set up four special officer roles:

website and membership;
gear and asset manager;
Navlight manager; and
International Rogaining Federation (IRF) representative.

These elected officers are regarded as having full rights and responsibilities of the Management Committee, and are additional to the Management Committee noted above.

The current suite of committee and regional representations is:

President
Secretary
Treasurer
General committee members (four, but varying year by year)
Gear/asset manager
Website and membership manager
Navlight manager
IRF representative
Regional representatives: Auckland, Central NI, Taranaki, Bay of Plenty, Wellington, Marlborough, Christchurch, Queenstown, Otago (these have largely been selected on an adhoc, pragmatic basis to capture as strong a regional presence as possible for rogaining and the NZRA.

3. Options for committee structural change

(Questions as per shaded box on page 1)

- Any changes needed to enhance delivering a truly national presence through the Management Committee, e.g., should the committee have a national spread?
- What is the status of the regional reps?

- Should regional reps. have Management Committee member status, or is their role a different one?
- Can the management committee and regional representation be more integrated?
- A sustainable organisation: What do we need to do, if anything, to ensure the association will be robust in say 5 years when some of the core initiators have a much reduced role.

4. Consideration of Committee structure, in terms of the above, at the November 2008 general committee meeting

The secretary tabled the above draft document 'Introducing a review of the management structure and regional representation of the NZRA'.

Discussion points

- Agreed need to improve national presence
- Agreed that regional reps have an unclearly defined role with respect to the core, Christchurch-centric committee.
- Noted that at the 2008 AGM it was agreed that regional representatives would be regarded as full committee members for 2008, taken as an interim solution, pending a review of the committee structure.
- Noted that current structure does not entirely align with that set out in the NZRA rules.
- No further specific solution beyond these steps is offered at this stage
- Better to work first with the existing structure, and then from a position of greater strength and experience, adjust the management structure and process to fit the need and reflect the preferred solution. ('*people before structure'*)

Decision: That we would experiment with committee meetings run as a tele or video conference. Conference calls are expensive, Skype offers a possible solution. *Action*: Emma and Phil to assess Skype options. We would aim to run the 2009 AGM as a national teleconference meeting.

Footnote: Planning for the 9th World Rogaining Championship in 2010 has accelerated the shift to teleconference meetings.